



**DARREN HARDY**

# **BRAND & DESIGN SYSTEM**

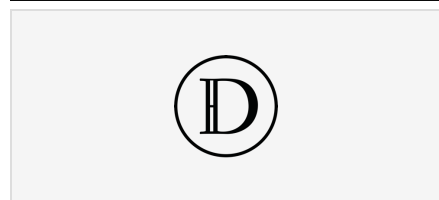
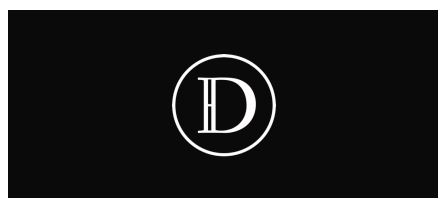
V1.0 · JUNE 2026

# LOGO SYSTEM

Three approved forms. The horizontal lockup — ornate D mark beside the tracked wordmark — is standard. Mark alone when the name is already established. Wordmark alone for text-only contexts.



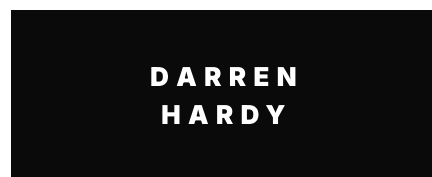
PRIMARY LOCKUP · DARK BACKGROUND (STANDARD USAGE)



MARK ONLY



LOCKUP · STANDARD



WORDMARK ONLY

## WORDMARK SPEC

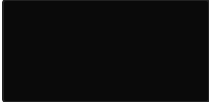
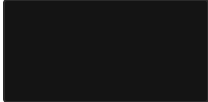
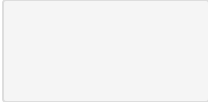
Inter 900 · letter-spacing: 0.28em · uppercase. Always weight 900. Minimum size 14px / 10pt. Never recolor, stretch, or set at a different weight.

## CLEAR SPACE & MISUSE

Minimum clear space = cap-height on all sides. Do not: add drop shadow, place on a busy photo without a dark scrim, use a weight other than 900, or break the wordmark to a second line in display contexts.

# COLOR SYSTEM

The palette is intentionally neutral. Surfaces are black or bone — never mid-grey. Silver and bone look similar as swatches but serve completely different roles: **silver is a type color, bone is a surface color**. The only brand hue is A-Team red, used exclusively on A-Team properties.

|                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                   |                                                                                    |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>BLACK</b><br>#0a0a0a                                                           | <b>INK</b><br>#141414                                                             | <b>BONE (SURFACE)</b><br>#f5f5f5                                                  | <b>SILVER (TYPE)</b><br>#b8b8b8                                                    | <b>MUTED (TYPE)</b><br>#444444                                                      | <b>A-TEAM RED</b><br>#A0252B                                                        |
| Page bg · primary dark surface                                                    | Nav bg · cards · dark ribbons                                                     | Light section bg · not a type color                                               | Body on dark · UI marks · spine                                                    | Body on light backgrounds                                                           | A-Team pages only — never on DH core                                                |

## DARK / LIGHT SECTION RULE

Pages alternate between dark sections (black bg + white/silver type) and light sections (bone bg + black/muted type). Never use a mid-grey background. The section border is always a 1px opacity token — never a solid grey line.

Dark · #0a0a0a  
type: silver / white

Light · #f5f5f5  
type: muted / black

## OPACITY DIVIDER TOKENS

--rule rgba(255,255,255,0.08) — hairline on dark  
--rule-strong rgba(255,255,255,0.15) — border on dark  
--rule-dark rgba(10,10,10,0.10) — hairline on light  
--rule-dark-strong rgba(10,10,10,0.18) — border on light

Never hard-code raw rgba. Always reference the token.

# TYPOGRAPHY

One typeface: **Inter** by Rasmus Andersson. Free for commercial use (SIL Open Font License). Download at [fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter](https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter) or [rsms.me/inter](https://rsms.me/inter). Every display heading is Inter Black (900) uppercase with tight tracking. Body is Inter Regular (400).

Hero close  
clamp(64px,10vw,170px)  
900 · ls -0.05em · lh 0.86

BE THE  
EXCEPTION.

Section heading  
clamp(51px,7.2vw,115px)  
900 · ls -0.04em · lh 0.92

ADVANTAGE

Magnet / H2  
clamp(32px,4.6vw,77px)  
900 · ls -0.035em · lh 0.95

THE 15-MINUTE  
CEO MORNING ROUTINE

Ghost numeral  
clamp(120px,16vw,230px)  
900 · ls -0.06em · color: transparent  
-webkit-text-stroke: 1px token

01

Eyebrow / nav  
10–11px · 500 · ls 0.38–0.42em  
uppercase · silver/grey-soft  
preceded by 28px pip line

— THE ECOSYSTEM

Body · dark bg  
clamp(17px,1.4vw,20px) · 400  
color: --silver · lh 1.6

Access to closely-guarded, insider strategies most founders never see.

Body · light bg  
clamp(17px,1.4vw,20px) · 400  
color: --muted · lh 1.6

What elite leaders do first thing to win the day.

## INTER — WEIGHT USAGE REFERENCE

**Aa**  
REGULAR  
400

Body copy

**Aa**  
MEDIUM  
500

Eyebrows · nav

**Aa**  
SEMIBOLD  
600

Ribbon labels

**Aa**  
BOLD  
700

Buttons · stat labels

**Aa**  
BLACK  
900

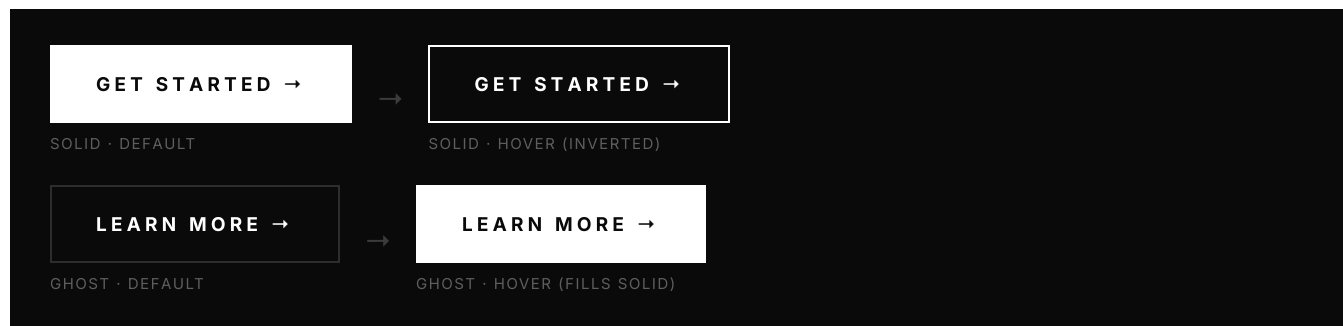
All headlines · wordmark

Download: [fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter](https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter) · [rsms.me/inter](https://rsms.me/inter) · License: SIL Open Font License 1.1 (free, commercial use permitted)

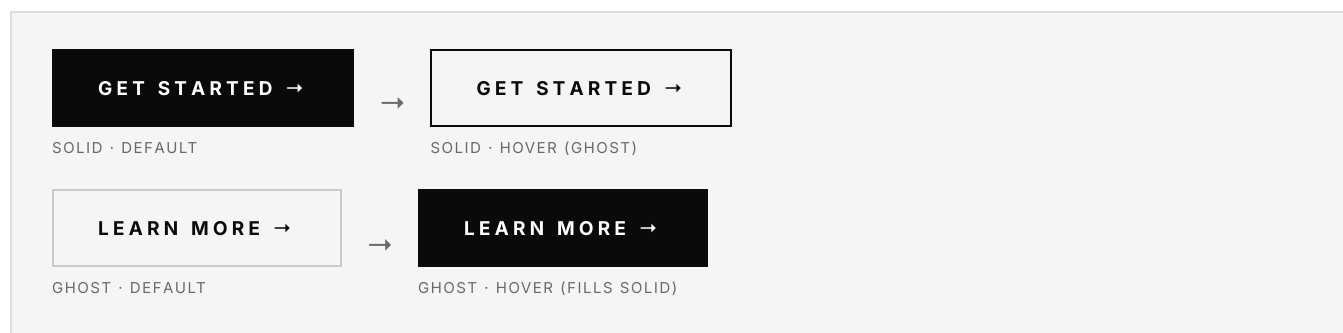
# BUTTONS & CTA SYSTEM

Two button variants. Each inverts on hover — solid becomes ghost, ghost becomes solid. States shown in pairs (default → hover). The shimmer CTA is reserved for the single primary acquisition action per page.

## ON DARK BACKGROUND



## ON LIGHT BACKGROUND (BONE)



## SHIMMER CTA · PRIMARY ACQUISITION ACTION ONLY



### BUTTON SPEC (ALL VARIANTS)

#### Padding

22px top/bottom  
44px left/right

#### Font

Inter 700  
12px · ls 0.24em

#### Border

1px solid  
(see variant)

#### Transition

all 0.2s  
no easing specified

# COMPONENTS & PATTERNS

The recurring UI primitives used across all DH web properties. Every component is built from the design tokens — no raw hex values in component code.

## EYEBROW + PIP



Inter 500 · 11px · ls 0.42em · uppercase · pip = 28px × 1px inline line preceding text

## NAVIGATION



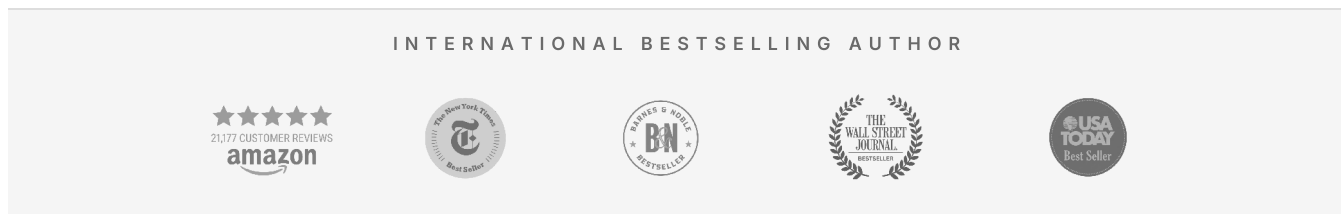
Fixed · backdrop-filter: blur(14px) · background: rgba(10,10,10,0.78) · border-bottom: var(--rule) · Brand name center at Inter 900 · 14px · ls 0.32em.

## RIBBON / MARQUEE — DARK (MEDIA CONTRIBUTOR)



background: --ink · logo filter: brightness(0) invert(1) · opacity 0.65 · 32s infinite scroll · SVGs + WebP PNGs

## RIBBON / MARQUEE — LIGHT (BESTSELLER AUTHOR)



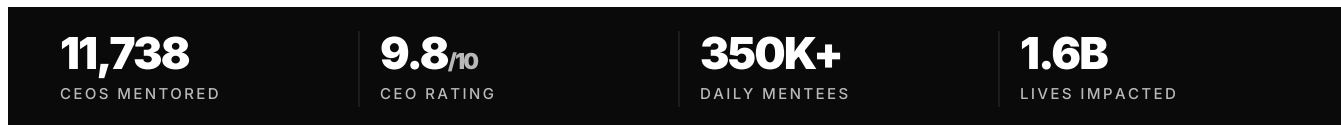
background: --bone · mix-blend-mode: multiply eliminates white bg · filter: grayscale(1) · badges 68px / 94px NYT · 28s scroll

## AWARD SEALS



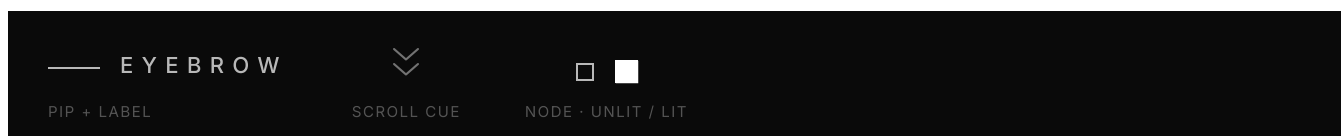
DD/DDOD: filter: invert(1) brightness(.58) · NSA: filter: brightness(1.35) (white on transparent — no invert) · NSA 10px taller than flanking seals

## STAT COUNTER



Inter 900 · clamp(58px, 7.2vw, 115px) · ls -0.04em · JS count-up on scroll. Cells: 88px top/bottom padding. Label: 500 · 13px · ls 0.18em.

## RECURRING MARKS — CORE DH



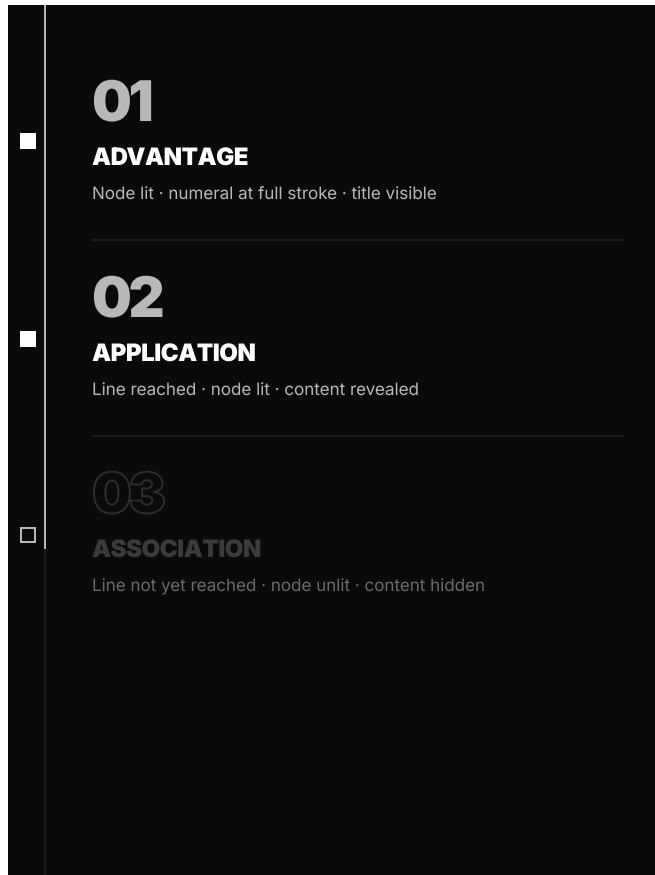
Darren Hardy Brand & Design System

RECURRING MARKS — A-TEAM CONTEXT ( --ACCENT: #A0252B )

Components · 05

# SPINE & NODE SYSTEM

The scroll-driven vertical spine is the primary interactive motif on the Ecosystem section and Manifesto close. A single line draws downward as the user scrolls, lighting each node as it passes. Ghost numerals and the "Be The Exception." headline brighten via CSS sibling selectors — no JS class changes needed for the visual state.



## SPINE TRACK

1px · `background:var(--rule)` · `left:20px` within `.aaa-stack`  
· spans full stack height

## SPINE FILL

Same position. Height set by JS `draw()` at `window.innerHeight`  
× 0.55 relative to stack top. Increase 0.55 to make the line lead  
ahead of viewport center; decrease to lag.

## NODE STATES

**Unlit:** 9×9px · transparent · `border:1px solid var(--silver)`

**Lit:** `background:var(--white)` · `border-color:var(--white)` ·  
`transform:scale(1.25)` · 0.35s ease

**Terminus (Be The Exception):** 11×11px · same states

## GHOST NUMERAL / HEADLINE TRIGGER

CSS sibling selector — no JS needed:

`.node.lit ~ .ghost-num` → stroke brightens to `var(--silver)`

`.node.lit ~ .man-title` → `color:var(--white)`, stroke fades  
to transparent

Body text ( `.col` ) reveals via `.aaa.in` set one-way by JS when  
line first hits each node.

# WEB IMPLEMENTATION

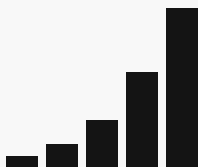
Live tokens and performance rules. Reference variables only — never hard-code raw hex in components.

```
/* — :root tokens (home.html, careers.html, resources.html ...) — */
:root {
  --black:#0a0a0a; --ink:#141414; --ink-soft:#1c1c1c;
  --white:#ffffff; --bone:#f5f5f5;
  --silver:#b8b8b8; --grey:#888888; --grey-soft:#6a6a6a; --muted:#444444;
  --rule:rgba(255,255,255,0.08); --rule-strong:rgba(255,255,255,0.15);
  --rule-dark:rgba(10,10,10,0.10); --rule-dark-strong:rgba(10,10,10,0.18);
}
```

## LAYOUT

Container max **1380px** · 48px side padding desktop · 24px mobile.

Section vertical padding: **120–160px** desktop · **80–100px** mobile.



## PERFORMANCE

Self-host Inter — no Google Fonts. All imagery in **.webp** · cover images max 600px wide. Background video via Vimeo `background=1` . Lazy-load below fold. `prefers-reduced-motion` honored.

## ACCESSIBILITY

Body text  $\geq 4.5:1$  contrast. Visible focus states on interactive elements. All images have descriptive `alt` text. Animations respect `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` .

## ANY PAGE OR CONTEXT REFERENCING "A-TEAM"

Add whenever the term "A-Team" appears on a page. Never on core DH pages (home / about / resources) where A-Team is not referenced.

```
--accent: #A0252B; /* A-Team red */
em { font-style: normal; color: var(--accent); } /* color-only emphasis, no italics */
.nobreak { white-space: nowrap; } /* e.g. <em class="nobreak">A-Team</em> */
```



# EMPHASIS & WORD CRAFT

The DH brand has no brand hue on core pages — emphasis is earned through scale, weight, and contrast alone. A single typographic rule keeps the voice consistent: **no italics, ever**. The `<em>` element is used semantically but its italic is overridden.

## RULE 1 · NO ITALICS

The brand never uses italics. Emphasis comes from size, weight, and uppercase — never font-style. Override the browser default:

```
em { font-style: normal; }
```

## RULE 2 · EMPHASIS = SCALE, NOT COLOR

On core DH pages, emphasized phrases earn weight through font-size or font-weight — not color. The page has no brand hue. Let scale do the work.

EMPHASIS MECHANICS — CORE DH (NO BRAND COLOR)

## THE ADVISOR BEHIND THE WORLD'S MOST DRIVEN BUSINESS BUILDERS

Scale + weight 900 = emphasis. No color shift needed.

For 35 years, he has been inside the rooms where **elite leaders, industry titans, and market makers** reveal how they think, decide, build, scale, and win.

In body: font-weight 700 + color: white = emphasis phrase. No italics.

## RULE 3 · .NOBREAK

Multi-word brand terms must never break across lines:

```
.nobreak { white-space: nowrap; }  
/* Usage: */  
<em class="nobreak">Be The Exception</em>.  
<em class="nobreak">The Compound Effect</em>
```

## RULE 4 · PUNCTUATION PLACEMENT

Closing punctuation goes **outside** the em:

```
✓ <em>Be The Exception</em>.  
✗ <em>Be The Exception.</em>
```

Exception: quoted exclamations keep punctuation inside.

# CTA SYSTEM

One primary action per page. The hierarchy is strict: a single conversion CTA closes each page or section — never two solid CTAs competing. Ghost CTAs provide low-pressure invitations earlier in the flow.

## CTA HIERARCHY

### TIER 1 · PRIMARY

One per page. Always the page-closing action. Solid black fill. The shimmer variant is used exclusively on the Start Here magnet CTA.

GET THE FREE GUIDE →

### TIER 2 · GHOST

Used in nav, early-section invitations, and secondary flows. Transparent background. Never competes with the primary CTA on the same view.

START HERE →

### TIER 3 · TEXT LINK

Nav links, footer links, inline references. Small, tracked, silver on dark. No border. Used when the destination is contextual, not conversion-focused.

DAILY MENTORING

## PAGE CTA PATTERN — HOW THEY COEXIST

### NAV

Ghost: "Start Here"



### PAGE BODY

No conversion CTA — content flows



### CLOSING SECTION

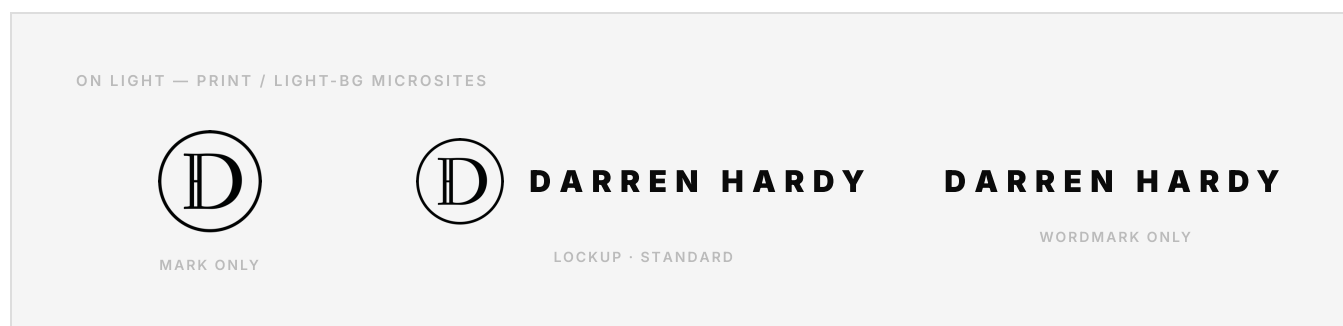
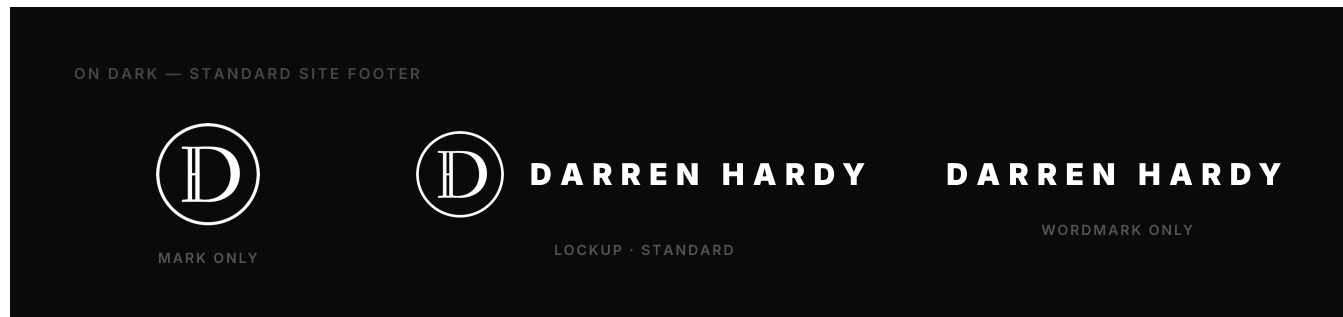
Solid primary: "Get The Free Guide"

## SHIMMER CTA — ONE INSTANCE, ONE PAGE

The silver shimmer sweep ( `rgba(210,210,230,0.32)` , 4s loop) is used **exclusively** on the "Get The Free Guide + Audio Series" button on the homepage. Never replicate on other pages or CTAs — it signals the single most important action on the site.

# FOOTER LOGO SYSTEM

The footer appears on every page. The lockup is standard. Mark alone when space is at a premium. All three forms are shown on both dark and light contexts.

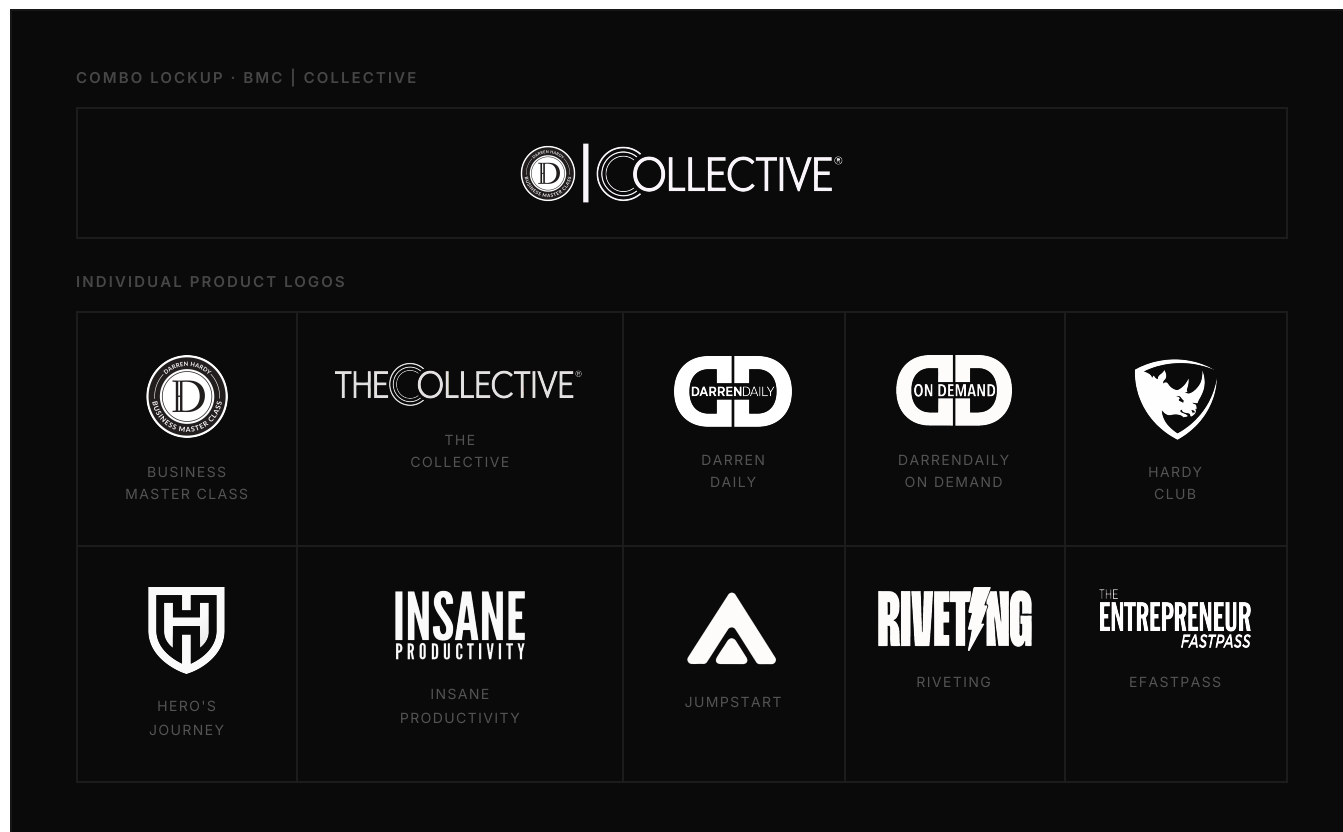


## FOOTER CODE SPEC

```
  
.dh-name : Inter 900 · 18px · ls 0.28em · uppercase · color:var(--white)
```

# PRODUCT LOGO SYSTEM

All DH product logos are white on transparent. They are always placed on dark backgrounds ( `--black` or `--ink` ). Never place on bone, white, or any light surface without a dark scrim behind them.



## USAGE RULE

All product logos are white on transparent. Always place on `--black` (`#0a0a0a`) or `--ink` (`#141414`). If a light-background context is unavoidable, place a dark panel or scrim behind the logo. Never recolor or place directly on bone or white.

## LOGO FILES

All logos are in `logos/products/` as `.webp`. PNG originals available in the DH asset library. Formats: all white on transparent PNG/WebP. Minimum display size varies by logo — check individual logo guide for each product.

BE THE  
EXCEPTION.

